

for improving fuel burning efficiency, putting in place disposal systems for fly ash to minimise pollution and dispersal/fugitive emissions of fly ash. The CECB also recommends the use of 'beneficiated' or washed coal in thermal power plants for enhancing energy output and efficiency, as well as recommending plantation and advocating the use of alternative fuels. With the entry of private players, a Significant growth is expected in the power sector while energy regulatory environment are being further strengthened to ensure access for all and balanced development that is sensitive towards safe-guarding the environment.



Empowering Farmers

Inspired by the objective of encouraging the farmers of Chhattisgarh for crop production and increasing the agricultural area, Bhupesh Baghel Chhattisgarh government launched Rajiv Gandhi Kisan Nyay Yojana on 21st May 2020, which is one of its kind largest scheme for the farmers in the country. In the state budget, a provision of INR 5700 crore was allocated for the welfare of farmers.

Chhattisgarh is basically an agrarian state with a total extent of cultivable land area of 46.77 lakh hectares. The state's 70 percent of the population is engaged in agriculture and around 37.46 lakh are farmers. This scheme aims at encouraging crop production and increasing agricultural acreage. The amount of Rs. 5750 crores provided under the scheme was transferred into the bank accounts of farmers in four instalments

benefitting 19 lakh farmers in the state. An amount of Rs 1745 crore as input subsidy was transferred directly into the bank accounts of 23.99 lakh farmers on 17 October 2022 for preparing the Kharif crop and it also includes those farmers who cultivate other crops instead of paddy, which is the main Kharif crop, and those who are into Plantation of trees.

Unemployment Allowance as Sustenance

The youth are the most treasured source of manpower of a state. Considering it a social obligation to extend financial support to jobless youth in the state and providing them with opportunities of skill development until they get employment, Chief Minister Baghel, during the presentation of the state's annual budget for FY 2023, announced the provision of a monthly unemployment allowance of Rs 250 crore for the educated youth,

effective April 1, 2023. This initiative is seen as a productive step in harnessing educated and skilled manpower for manning the growing development projects of the state for economic self-reliance of Chhattisgarh.

Those educated youth who have passed the 12th standard and are unemployed, and having a family income of less than Rs 2.5 lakhs per annum are eligible for the monthly allowance scheme. Only one member of a family can apply for it. The beneficiary must meet the mandatory eligibility criteria by first enrolling in a self-employment guidance centre and any district employment guidance centre in the state of Chhattisgarh. Additionally, the applicant must have his employment registration in the prescribed format for at least two years as on April 1 of the year of application to be eligible for the allowance. Once sanctioned, the allowance will be credited directly to the bank accounts of all eligible applicants. For those youth who fail to secure a job a year after receiving the monthly allowance, their monthly allowance will be extended by the state government. Moreover, those who have declined a job offer from the government or private sector, will cease to be eligible for the allowance.

To ensure that the really needy are not deprived of their right to benefit from the scheme, unemployed youth who are family members of ministers, former ministers, chairman and former chairmen of municipal corporations and municipal councils, members of parliament and legislative assembly, are not eligible for the scheme.

